

How to Do Intent-First Keyword Research

A step-by-step process to pick the right page type before you chase search volume.

What Is This Guide?

Use intent to decide the asset (blog, landing, comparison, service) before you expand a keyword list. You will get faster wins and avoid writing the wrong page.

At a Glance

#	Step	What you do
1	Capture raw keywords	Pull queries from DataForSEO, GSC, and competitor SERPs into a sheet.
2	Label intent	Mark each term as Informational, Navigational, Commercial, or Transactional.
3	Pick page format	Map intent to the page type and CTA you'll build.
4	Prioritise & ship	Schedule pages by impact; publish weekly drops.

Step 1 · Capture raw keywords

Open DataForSEO (or your crawler/GSC export) and collect 200–500 queries around your topic. Keep the exact query text and the originating source.

Step 2 · Label intent

- Informational — user wants to learn (how, what, why, guide).
- Navigational — user wants a specific brand/site (brand name, login, app).
- Commercial — user is comparing options (best, vs, review, top, pricing).
- Transactional — user is ready to act (buy, book, near me, quote, demo).

How to tag fast

Bulk classify with a simple prompt or regex cues: vs/best → commercial, buy/price/near me → transactional, brand terms → navigational. Spot-check 20 rows manually.

Step 3 · Map intent to page format

Intent	Page type	Primary CTA
Informational	Blog guide or FAQ cluster	Subscribe / download kit
Navigational	Homepage or product hub	Try / contact
Commercial	Comparison or category page	See plans / view offer
Transactional	Service/landing page with form	Book / buy / get quote

Step 4 · Prioritise and ship

Sort by: (1) intent fit to your offer, (2) business value, (3) effort. Ship one page per week at minimum; pair each launch with an IG reel.

Why this works

Intent alignment makes format, CTA, and schema match what the searcher expects. That's how you outrank higher-authority sites without chasing raw volume.

Next drops

Live demo: harvest keywords with DataForSEO.

Template: intent-tagging Google Sheet (with cues & formulas).

Walkthrough: build comparison vs landing for the same keyword set.

CTA

Comment "WORD DOC" and I'll send the worksheet. Follow for the next reel where we generate and tag keywords live.